

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF KINGS

-----X
ASHLEY LAWRENCE,

Plaintiff,

-against-

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, NEW YORK CITY
POLICE DEPARTMENT, POLICE OFFICER
CATHERINE FARLEY SHIELD # 12775,
POLICE OFFICER DAVID A. RICHTER SHIELD #2577,
POLICE OFFICER "JOHN DOE" and POLICE OFFICER
"JANE DOE",

Defendants.

-----X
To the above named Defendant(s)

Index #

Date Filed:

Plaintiff designates

COUNTY OF KINGS

as the place of trial

Basis of venue is

Location of Occurrence

SUMMONS

Location of Occurrence

Borough Hall Station

Brooklyn, NY

COUNTY OF KINGS

You are hereby summoned to answer the complaint in this action and to serve a copy of your answer, or, if the complaint is not served with this summons, to serve a notice of appearance, on the Plaintiff's attorneys within 20 days after the service of this summons, exclusive of the day of service (or within 30 days after the service is complete if this summons is not personally delivered to you within the State of New York); and in case of your failure to appear or answer, judgment will be taken against you by default for the relief demanded in the complaint.

Dated: Flushing, New York
February 14, 2024



THE ORLOW FIRM

By: Brian S. Orlow

Attorney for Plaintiff

OFFICE & P.O. ADDRESS

71-18 Main Street

Flushing, NY 11367

(718) 544-4100

DEFENDANTS' ADDRESSES:

THE CITY OF NEW YORK
00 Church Street
New York, NY 10007

NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT
1 Police Plaza
New York, NY 10001

POLICE OFFICER CATHERINE FARLEY
SHIELD #12775
200 Schermerhorn Street
Brooklyn, NY 11201

POLICE OFFICER DAVID A. RICHTER
SHIELD #2577
200 Schermerhorn Street
Brooklyn, NY 11201

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF KINGS

Index #

-----X
ASHLEY LAWRENCE,

Plaintiff,

VERIFIED COMPLAINT

- against -

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, NEW YORK CITY
POLICE DEPARTMENT, POLICE OFFICER CATHERINE
FARLEY SHIELD # 12775, POLICE OFFICER DAVID A.
RICHTER SHIELD #2577, POLICE OFFICER "JOHN DOE"
and POLICE OFFICER "JANE DOE",

Defendants.
-----X

The plaintiff, complaining of the defendants, by her attorneys, THE ORLOW FIRM, respectfully shows to this Court and alleges:

1. Upon information and belief, that at all times hereinafter mentioned, the defendant THE CITY OF NEW YORK, was and still is a municipal corporation duly organized and existing under and by virtue of the laws of the State of New York.

2. Upon information and belief, NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT is a subdivision of the defendant, THE CITY OF NEW YORK.

3. Upon information and belief, that at all times hereinafter mentioned, the defendant, THE CITY OF NEW YORK and NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT, their agents, servants and employees operated, maintained and controlled the NYPD Transit Bureau District 30, including all the police officers thereof.

4. Upon information and belief, that at all times hereinafter mentioned, and on or prior to the 7th day of June, 2023, POLICE OFFICER CATHERINE FARLEY SHIELD #12775, POLICE OFFICER DAVID A. RICHTER SHIELD #2577, POLICE OFFICERS "JOHN DOE" and POLICE OFFICER "JANE DOE", were employed by the defendant, NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT, as Police Officers.

5. That a Notice of the Plaintiff's claim, including the nature of the claim and the date of, the time when, the place where and the manner in which the claim arose, was duly served upon The New York City Comptroller's Office, on or about the 24th day of July, 2023.

6. That a hearing pursuant to section 50H of the General Municipal Law was held on January 23, 2024.

7. That more than 30 days have elapsed since the Notice of Claim has been served upon the defendants and the said defendants have neglected or refused to make any adjustment or payment thereof.

8. That this action is commenced within one year and 90 days after the causes of action arose.

**AS AND FOR A FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION FOR NEGLIGENCE AGAINST THE
CITY OF NEW YORK AND THE NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT**

9. That on or about the 7th day of June, 2023 at Bourrough Hall Station, County of Kings, in the City and State of New York, where plaintiff resides, the defendants, their agents, servants and employees improperly detained plaintiff, ASHLEY LAWRENCE.

10. That at the aforesaid date and time while Plaintiff was being detained, Plaintiff was unlawfully and violently assaulted by Defendant, POLICE OFFICER CATHERINE FARLEY SHIELD #12775, POLICE OFFICER DAVID A. RICHTER SHIELD #2577, POLICE OFFICERS "JOHN DOE" and POLICE OFFICER "JANE DOE", who threatened and attacked the Plaintiff causing severe and serious physical and psychological injuries to the Plaintiff.

11. It was the duty of the defendants, THE CITY OF NEW YORK and THE NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT, to use reasonable care in the hiring, training and retaining of the police officers in their employ and to supervise those police officers to make sure their interactions with the public are proper.

12. That the Defendants, THE CITY OF NEW YORK and NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT, their agents, servants and/or employees, disregarded their duty to protect the Plaintiff, by negligently hiring and retaining said police officers, failed to adequately train them to act as reasonably prudent police officers and failed to prevent the aforesaid police officers from utilizing a form of cruel and unusual punishment on the aforesaid Plaintiff by threatening, assaulting and attacking the Plaintiff, and inflicting injuries upon the Plaintiff, and took no action to stop these unlawful acts.

13. That Defendants, THE CITY OF NEW YORK and NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT, their agents, servants and/or employees negligently and carelessly failed to take all reasonable and necessary precautions to prevent the aforesaid occurrence.

14. Upon information and belief, that at the time and place aforesaid, the Defendants, THE CITY OF NEW YORK and NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT, had actual knowledge and notice of the vicious and dangerous propensities of the Police Officers who attacked the Plaintiff, or the same had existed for sufficient length of time prior to the occurrence herein alleged that the Defendants could and should have had such knowledge and notice.

15. That solely and wholly as a result of the negligence of the Defendants as aforesaid, Plaintiff suffered severe and serious injuries and Plaintiff has been informed and believes that she will continue to suffer therefrom for an indefinite time in the future and that some of said injuries are permanent in nature.

16. That by reason of the negligence of the Defendants as aforesaid, the Plaintiff has been damaged in an amount which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all other courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction.

AS AND FOR A SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION FOR NEGLIGENCE
AGAINST POLICE OFFICER CATHERINE FARLEY SHIELD #12775, POLICE
OFFICER DAVID A. RICHTER SHIELD #2577, POLICE OFFICERS "JOHN DOE" and
POLICE OFFICER "JANE DOE"

17. Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in the foregoing paragraphs of this complaint with the same force and effect as if set forth fully herein.

18. That it was the duty of the defendants, POLICE OFFICER CATHERINE FARLEY SHIELD #12775, POLICE OFFICER DAVID A. RICHTER SHIELD #2577, POLICE OFFICERS "JOHN DOE" and POLICE OFFICER "JANE DOE", to use reasonable care in the execution of their duties as police officers and to act in a reasonably prudent manner in their interactions with the public.

19. That the defendants, POLICE OFFICER CATHERINE FARLEY SHIELD #12775, POLICE OFFICER DAVID A. RICHTER SHIELD #2577, POLICE OFFICERS "JOHN DOE" and POLICE OFFICER "JANE DOE", and the defendants, THE CITY OF NEW YORK and NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT, their agents, servants and employees negligently, carelessly and recklessly performed their police duties in that they failed to use such care in the performance of their police duties as a reasonably prudent and careful police officer would have used under similar circumstances in that they carelessly, recklessly and negligently detained the plaintiff without making a proper investigation; in that they were negligent, careless and reckless in the manner in which they performed, controlled and conducted their investigation; and in that the defendants, their agents, servants and employees were otherwise careless, reckless and negligent.

20. That by reason of the negligence of the Defendants as aforesaid, the Plaintiff has been damaged in an amount which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all other courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction.

AS AND FOR A THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION FOR ASSAULT

21. Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in the

foregoing paragraphs of this complaint with the same force and effect as if set forth fully herein.

22. That the Defendant, POLICE OFFICER CATHERINE FARLEY SHIELD #12775, POLICE OFFICER DAVID A. RICHTER SHIELD #2577, POLICE OFFICERS "JOHN DOE" and POLICE OFFICER "JANE DOE", intentionally caused Plaintiff, to experience a reasonable apprehension that an immediate, harmful and offensive contact would be applied to his person.

23. By virtue of the aforesaid intentional acts of these defendants, the plaintiff, ASHLEY LAWRENCE, suffered severe and serious injuries as aforesaid.

24. That by reason of the actions of the Defendants as aforesaid, the Plaintiff has been damaged in an amount which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all other courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction.

AS FOR A FOURTH CAUSE OF ACTION
FOR BATTERY

25. Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in the foregoing paragraphs of this complaint with the same force and effect as if set forth fully herein.

26. That the defendants, POLICE OFFICER CATHERINE FARLEY SHIELD #12775, POLICE OFFICER DAVID A. RICHTER SHIELD #2577, POLICE OFFICERS "JOHN DOE" and POLICE OFFICER "JANE DOE", intentionally caused a harmful and offensive contact to be applied to the person of the Plaintiff, ASHLEY LAWRENCE.

27. By virtue of the aforesaid intentional acts of these defendants, the Plaintiff, ASHLEY LAWRENCE, suffered severe and serious injuries as aforesaid.

28. That by reason of the actions of the Defendants as aforesaid, the Plaintiff has been damaged in an amount which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all other courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction.

AS FOR A FIFTH CAUSE OF ACTION
FOR EXCESSIVE FORCE

29. Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in the foregoing paragraphs of this complaint with the same force and effect as if set forth fully herein.

30. That the Defendants, their agents, servants and/or employees caused, permitted and/or allowed Plaintiff, to be assaulted, as aforesaid and in using excessive and unlawful force During the course of her arrest.

31. That as a result of the foregoing occurrence, Plaintiff sustained internal and external personal injuries and will continue to suffer physical pain and mental anguish as a result thereof, and upon information and belief, the aforesaid injuries are of permanent and lasting nature.

32. That by reason of the negligence of the Defendants as aforesaid, the Plaintiff has been damaged in an amount which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all other courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction.

PLAINTIFF'S SIXTH CAUSE OF ACTION FOR FALSE ARREST

33. That on or about the 7th day of June, 2023, the Defendants wrongfully and falsely accused, arrested and imprisoned the plaintiff, ASHLEY LAWRENCE, and accused her of crimes.

34. That the said arrest and imprisonment was caused by the Defendants, their agents, servants and employees, without any warrant or other legal process and without authority of the law and without any reasonable cause of belief that the Plaintiff was in fact guilty of such crimes.

35. While the plaintiff was so engaged, as aforesaid, the Defendants, their agents, servants and employees, wrongfully and unlawfully, against the Plaintiff's wish, without probable or reasonable cause, and on the sole charge, then made, that Plaintiff was violating the penal law of the State of New York, arrested and imprisoned the plaintiff and with full force of arms, forcibly and violently seized, and laid hold of and compelled plaintiff to go with the said defendant police officers to be detained and imprisoned in or near premises known and designated as the NYPD Transit Bureau District 30 located in the County of Kings, City and State of New York until she was released on her own recognizance.

36. That the Defendants, their agents, servants and employees, acting within the scope of their authority and within the scope of their employment, detained and imprisoned the Plaintiff even though the Defendants, their agents, servants and employees knew, had the opportunity to know, or should have known, that the allegations against the plaintiff were wrongful, unlawful and without a sufficient basis in fact.

37. That the Plaintiff was wholly innocent of the said criminal charges and did not contribute in any way to the conduct of the Defendants, their agents, servants and employees and was forced by the Defendants to submit to the aforesaid arrest and imprisonment thereto entirely against her will.

38. That as a result of the aforesaid accusations made by the defendants, their agents, servants and employees acting under their employment and within the scope of their authority, made falsely, publicly, wickedly and maliciously, the plaintiff was compelled to appear before a Judge of the Criminal Court of the City of New York.

39. That the defendants, their agents, servants and employees, as set forth on the aforementioned date, time and place, intended to confine the plaintiff; in that the plaintiff was conscious of the confinement; plaintiff did not consent to the confinement; and the confinement was not otherwise privileged.

40. That by reason of the false arrest, imprisonment and detention of the plaintiff, plaintiff was subjected to great indignities, humiliation and ridicule, in being so detained, charged and prosecuted with various crimes, and greatly injured in her credit and circumstances and was then and there prevented and hindered from performing and transacting her necessary affairs and business, and was caused to suffer much pain in both mind and body, the loss of employment and the loss of employment opportunities.

41. That solely and wholly as a result of the negligence of the Defendants as aforesaid, Plaintiff suffered severe and serious injuries and Plaintiff has been informed and believes that she will continue to suffer therefrom for an indefinite time in the future and that some of said injuries are permanent in nature.

42. That by reason of the negligence of the Defendants as aforesaid, the Plaintiff has been damaged in an amount which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all other courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction.

AS AND FOR A SEVENTH CAUSE OF ACTION PURSUANT TO 42 U.S.C. 1983

43. Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in the foregoing paragraphs of this complaint with the same force and effect as if set forth fully herein.

44. In detaining the Plaintiff, ASHLEY LAWRENCE, Defendant, POLICE OFFICER CATHERINE FARLEY SHIELD #12775, POLICE OFFICER DAVID A. RICHTER SHIELD #2577, POLICE OFFICERS "JOHN DOE" and POLICE OFFICER "JANE DOE", used physical force which was clearly excessive in light of the circumstances existing at the time of the arrest and/or detention. Defendants used such force with the intent to inflict unnecessary harm on the plaintiff and such use of force did cause physical and mental injuries to plaintiff.

45. The arrest of Plaintiff and the use of excessive force by the Defendants, POLICE OFFICER CATHERINE FARLEY SHIELD #12775, POLICE OFFICER DAVID A. RICHTER SHIELD #2577, POLICE OFFICERS "JOHN DOE" and POLICE OFFICER "JANE DOE", in the detention of the plaintiff, violated plaintiff's right under the Eighth Amendment of the United States Constitution to be free from cruel and unusual punishment and Plaintiff's right under the Fourteenth Amendment of the United States Constitution to due process of law.

46. Plaintiff's detention was made under color of law and under color of the authority of the Defendants, THE CITY OF NEW YORK and NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT, by the Defendants, POLICE OFFICER CATHERINE FARLEY SHIELD #12775, POLICE OFFICER DAVID A. RICHTER SHIELD #2577, POLICE OFFICERS "JOHN DOE" and POLICE OFFICER "JANE DOE", as police officers for The City of New York.

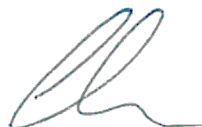
47. The violation of Plaintiff's constitutional rights was caused by the implementation of a custom, policy or official act of the Defendants, their agents, servants and employees in that they failed to adequately and properly hire, retain, train, supervise, discipline or in any other way control the behavior and performance of the defendants, their agents, servants and employees and in their hiring practices in the exercise of their police functions and their failure to enforce the laws of the State and City of New York is evidence of the reckless lack of cautious regard for the rights of the public including plaintiff and exhibited a lack of that degree of due care which prudent and reasonable individuals would show in executing the duties of the defendants.

48. The failure of the Defendants, THE CITY OF NEW YORK and NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT, their agents, servants and employees to hire, train, supervise, discipline or in any other way control the defendants, in the exercise of their functions and their failure to enforce the laws of the City and State of New York was and is carried out wilfully, wantonly, maliciously and with such reckless disregard for the consequences as to display a conscious disregard for the dangers of harm and injury to the citizens of the State and of New York including plaintiff.

49. That by reason of the negligence of the Defendants as aforesaid, the Plaintiff has been damaged in an amount which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all other courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction.

WHEREFORE, Plaintiff demands judgment against the Defendants in an amount which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all other courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction.

Dated: Flushing, New York
February 14, 2024



THE ORLOW FIRM
By: Brian S. Orlow
Attorneys for Plaintiff
Office and P.O. Address
71-18 Main Street
Flushing, New York 11367

Re: Lawrence, A.

ATTORNEY VERIFICATION

I, the undersigned, an attorney admitted to practice in the Courts of New York State, state that I am the attorney of record for the Plaintiff in the within action; I have read the foregoing **SUMMONS AND COMPLAINT** and know the contents thereof, the same is true to my own knowledge, except as to the matters therein stated to be alleged on information and belief, and as to those matters I believe it to be true. The reason this verification is made by me and not by the Plaintiff is that the Plaintiff currently resides in a County other than the County in which our office is located. The grounds of my belief as to all matters not stated upon my own knowledge are as follows: Information based on our office file.

I affirm that the foregoing statements are true, under the penalties of perjury.

Dated: Flushing, New York
February 14, 2024



BRIAN S. ORLOW

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF KINGS

ASHLEY LAWRENCE,

Plaintiff,

-against-

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, NEW YORK CITY
POLICE DEPARTMENT, POLICE OFFICER CATHERINE
FARLEY SHIELD # 12775, POLICE OFFICER DAVID A.
RICHTER SHIELD #2577, POLICE OFFICER "JOHN DOE"
and POLICE OFFICER "JANE DOE",

Defendants.

SUMMONS & VERIFIED COMPLAINT

THE ORLOW FIRM
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(718) 544-4100
